
Chapter 7 — Group 7

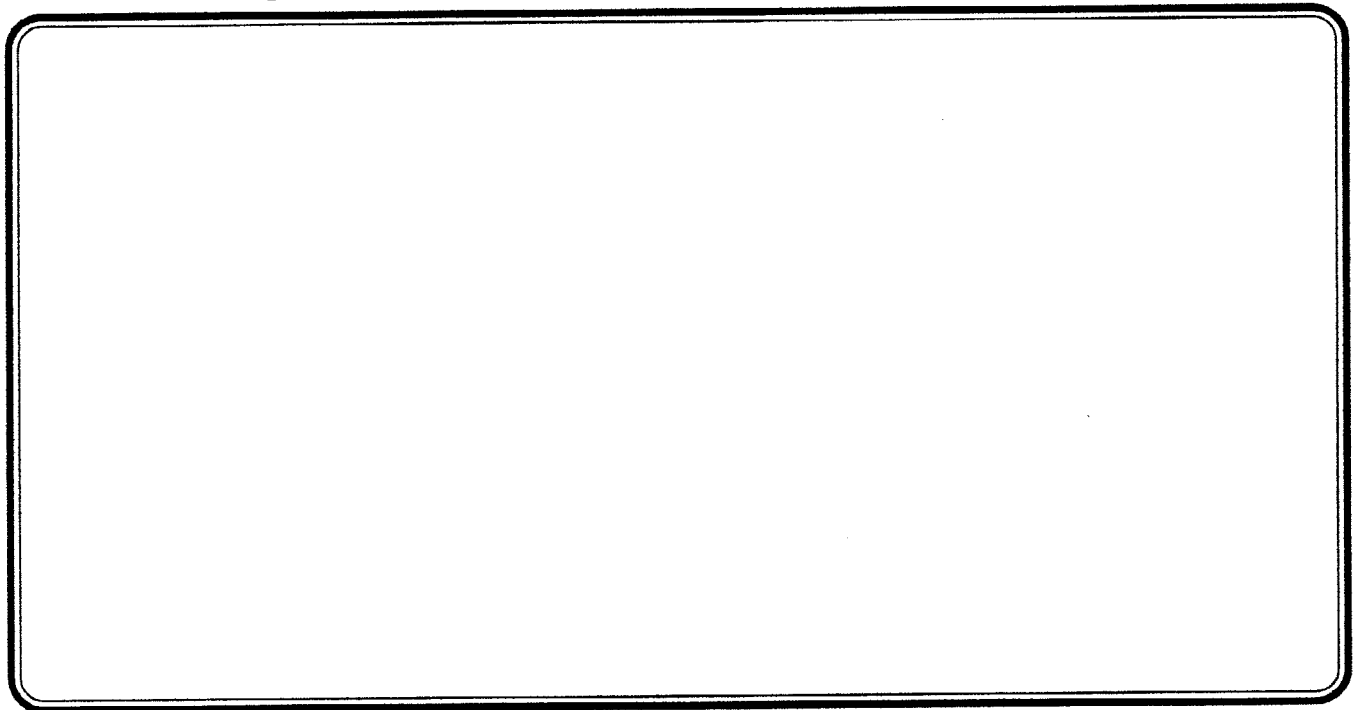
EXPLORING YOUR TRUE SELF

[Instructions: Read this chapter prior to coming to your next group. Answer the questions before coming to group. You will share your responses in group.]

As discussed in prior groups, one problem many people have in relationships is that they develop a false-self. Remember that the false-self develops because of codependent involvement with others. It is a negative pattern of behaviors, feelings, and ideas (beliefs) we form as we try to control negative relationships.

1. Drawing Your False-Self

In the space below, draw a picture of your false-self. Think about ways you act and emotions you feel that you sometimes believe or feel “aren’t really you.” Be sure to write some feelings of the false self, some behaviors, and some of its beliefs. For example, you might write: “My false-self feels empty without this other person.” “My false-self acts (behaves) as if I’m a jealous child.” “My false-self believes that I can’t survive without this person. It believes that I’m weak.”



My False-Self

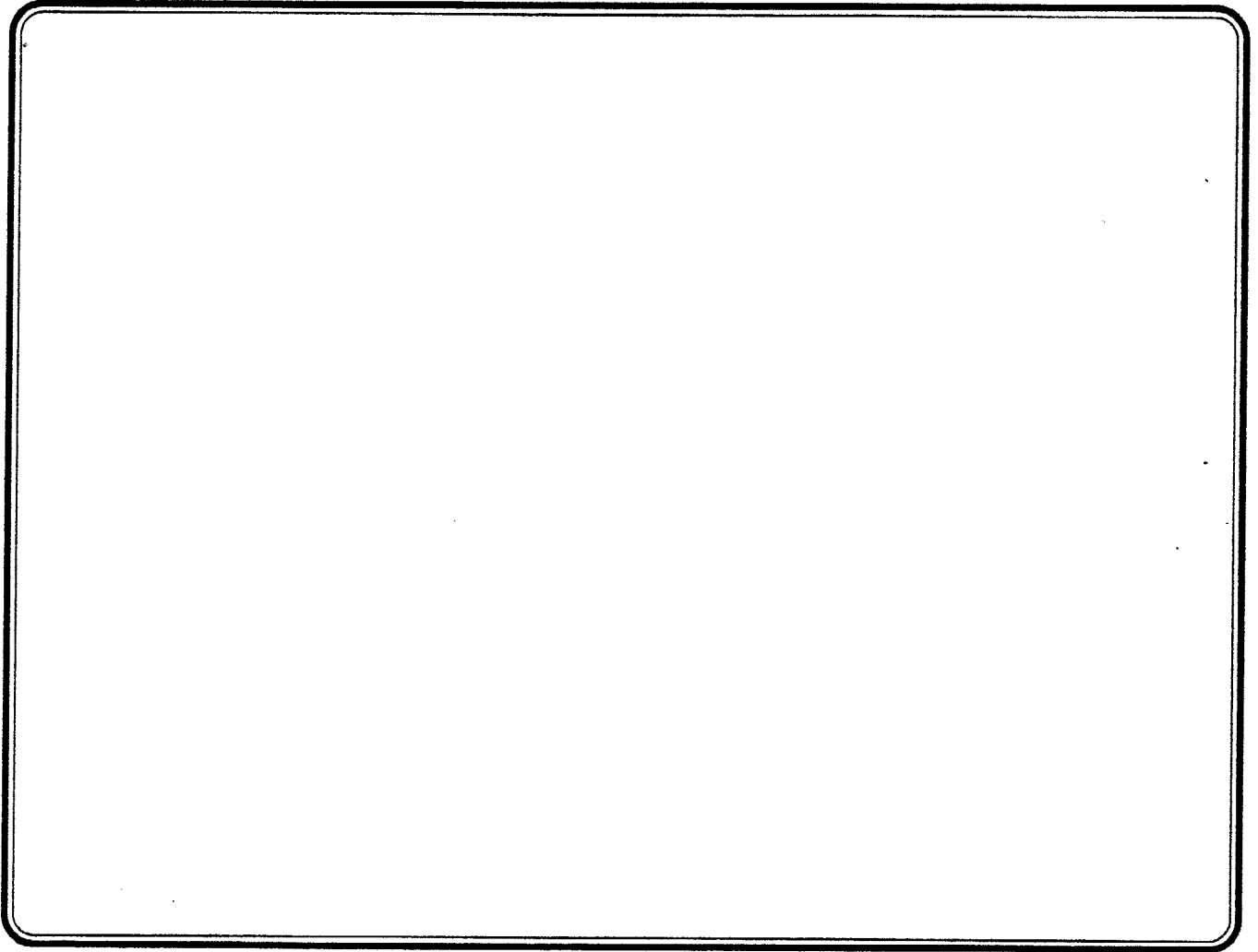
What are some of the behaviors that come from your false-self? _____

What are some feelings that come from your false-self? _____

What are some beliefs that come from your false-self? _____

2. Drawing Your Real-Self — Your Inner Self

In the space below, draw a picture of your real-self. Think about what and how you really are. Remember that the Inner Self contains your positive potentials — your abilities and aspirations to become the best you can be. It tells you that you can be successful and urges you to become better and better. Be sure to write some feelings of the real self, some behaviors, and some of its beliefs. For example, you might write: “My real-self feels I am a good person.” “My real-self acts (behaves) like I can do just about anything I want.” “My real-self believes that I can survive with or without that person. It believes that I’m strong.”



My Real-Self

What are some of the behaviors that come from your real-self? _____

What are some feelings that come from your real-self? _____

What are some beliefs that come from your real-self? _____

If you have filled out this chapter before group and successfully shared your responses with the group, you will be asked to move on to the next chapter.